

What Yonkers Residents Complain About

The leading grievances in public comments on the City of Yonkers' official
Facebook and Instagram accounts
March – July 2026

Period analysed	March – July 2026
Months carrying comments	Mar 2026 – Jul 2026
Comments collected	2,173
Of which substantive	1,473 (excludes emoji-only and tag-only replies)
Complaints identified	191 (13.0% of substantive)
Sources	facebook.com/cityofyonkers · instagram.com/cityofyonkers
Prepared	August 08, 2026

How this was built

Public comments were collected from the City of Yonkers' official Facebook page and Instagram account covering March – July 2026. Every comment was screened for grievance language — complaint markers such as demands to fix something, reports of neglect, questions about why a problem persists, or explicit expressions of frustration. Comments that were purely congratulatory, informational, or off-topic were excluded from the counts.

2,173 comments were collected. A large share of any city page's replies are emoji, tags and one-word reactions, which express no grievance either way, so the **1,473** comments carrying actual prose form the base for every rate in this report. Of those, **191 (13.0%)** registered as complaints and were sorted into civic categories using a weighted keyword classifier. A single comment can touch more than one issue; it is counted once under its dominant theme, with secondary themes tracked separately under “mentions.”

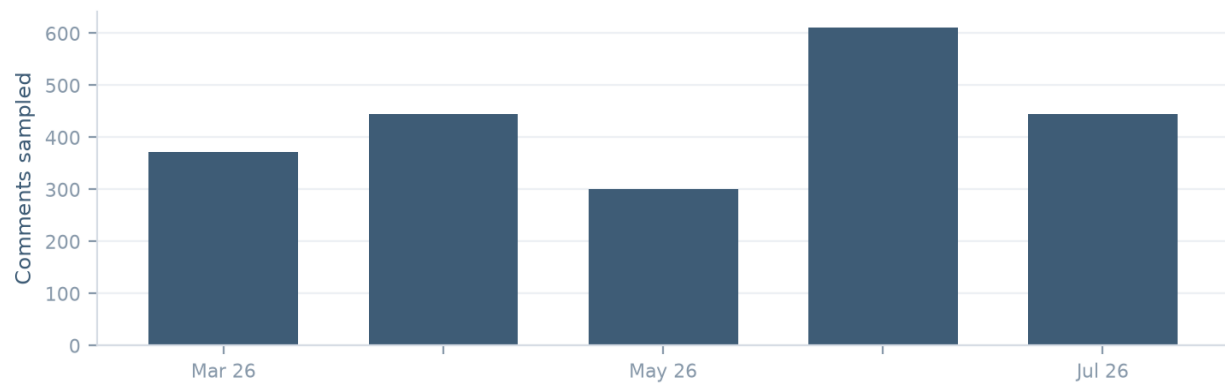
What the numbers do and don't represent

These are the complaints residents chose to post publicly on the city's own channels. They are a strong signal of what frustrates the engaged public, but they are not a representative survey of all Yonkers residents. Comment volume is also shaped by what the city posts about and by moderation. Read the ranking as *what dominates the public conversation*, not as a measured incidence of each problem across the city.

Collection notes

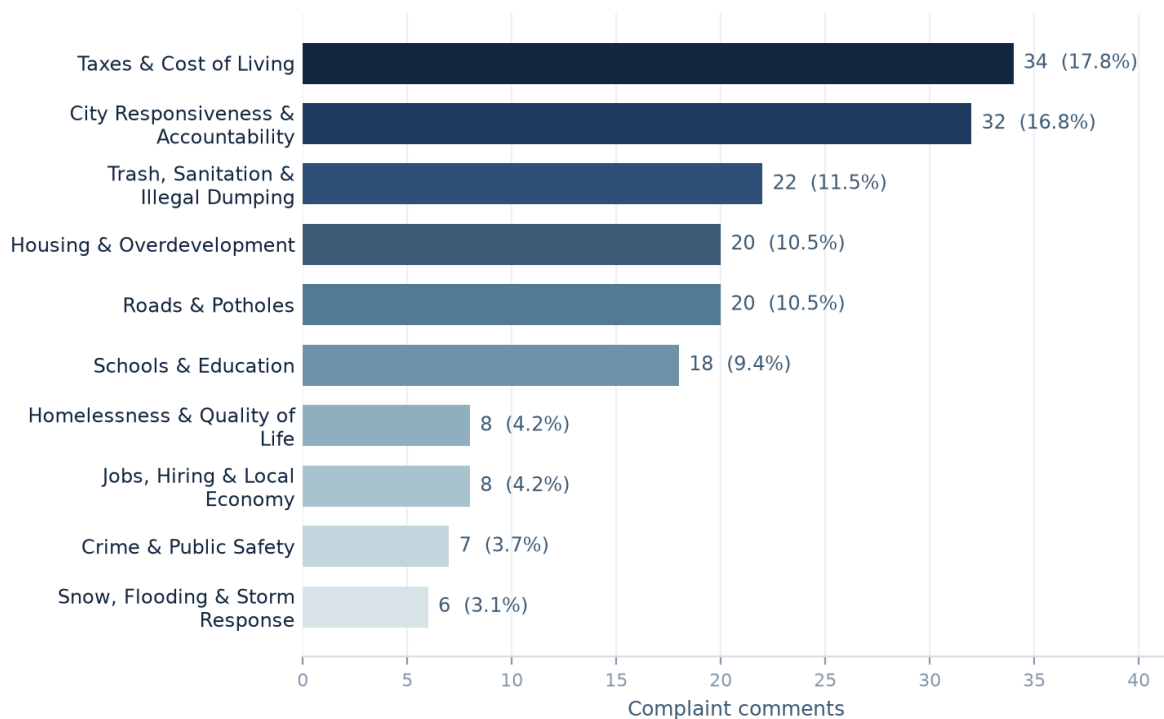
- Coverage for this window: 267 Facebook posts and 141 Instagram posts were sampled. Facebook's public feed is paged in date-bounded slices, so this is a sample of the period rather than every post the city published in it.
- Facebook comments were pulled from the most-commented posts inside the window. Heavily discussed posts are over-represented on purpose - that is where grievances collect - so these shares describe the complaint conversation, not the average post.
- Instagram contributes the comments returned alongside each post, a broader but shallower slice than Facebook.
- Emoji-only, tag-only and one-word reactions are counted in the total collected but excluded from the base used for the complaint rate, since they express no grievance either way.
- Comments posted by official city accounts are excluded, as the scrapers surface them alongside residents' replies.
- A category can rank low simply because the city rarely posted about it in this window. Treat the ranking as a measure of the conversation the city's own posts invited, not a census of civic opinion.

Comments sampled by month



The top 10 complaints

Taxes & Cost of Living is the single largest source of complaints, accounting for 17.8% of every grievance posted. The three leading themes — Taxes & Cost of Living, City Responsiveness & Accountability, Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping — together make up 46% of all complaints, meaning most of what residents raise on the city's channels concentrates in a handful of recurring issues.

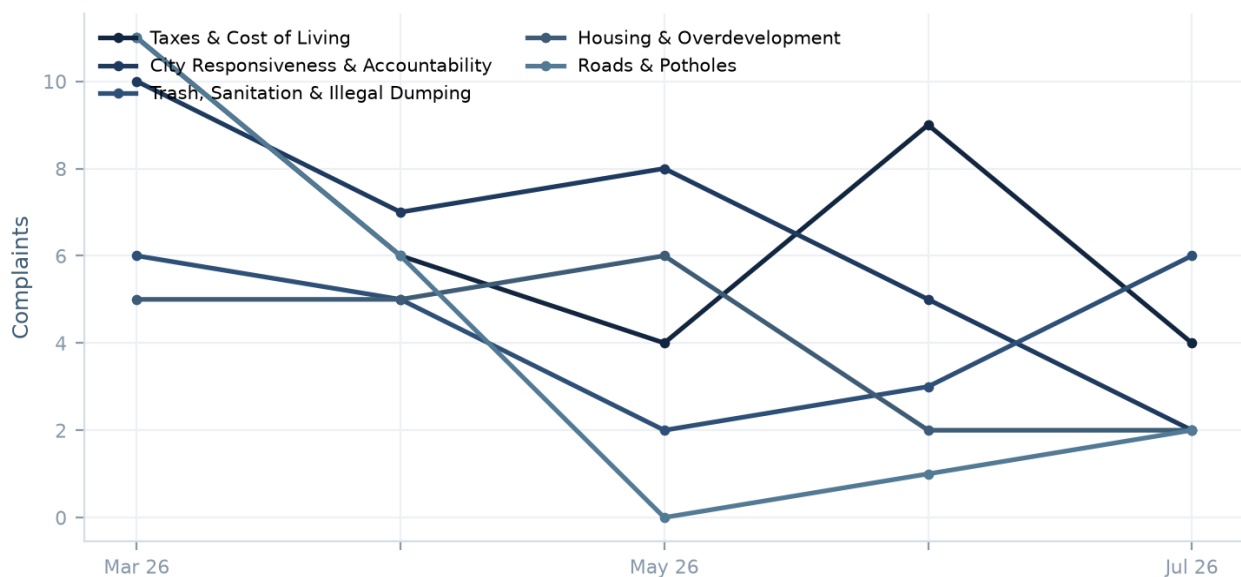


#	Complaint category	Comments	Share	Avg. likes
1	Taxes & Cost of Living	34	17.8%	5.2
2	City Responsiveness & Accountability	32	16.8%	2.8
3	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	22	11.5%	1.6
4	Housing & Overdevelopment	20	10.5%	2.3
5	Roads & Potholes	20	10.5%	5.4
6	Schools & Education	18	9.4%	3.4
7	Homelessness & Quality of Life	8	4.2%	1.1
8	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	8	4.2%	2.8
9	Crime & Public Safety	7	3.7%	0.1
10	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	6	3.1%	1.7

How the top issues moved over time

Monthly complaint counts for the five largest categories. Peaks follow a specific triggering event — a snowstorm, a violent incident, a budget vote — that pulls a burst of comment traffic onto the city's posts.

Read month-to-month movement with care. These lines track how much was sampled as much as how much was said — a month with few sampled comments cannot produce many complaints. Check the sampling volume on the methodology page before reading any swing as a real change in resident sentiment.



The complaints in residents' own words

Each category below shows its rank, volume, and a selection of verbatim comments. Quotes are reproduced as posted, including spelling and punctuation. Commenter names are omitted.

1

Taxes & Cost of Living

34 complaints · 17.8% of all complaints · Facebook 25 · Instagram 9



"We need lower property TAX, and better ROADS."

Facebook · 2026 · 14 likes · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

"Financial accountability. What does the city do with the funds they grab from tax payers? Cost of living is ridiculous in this city run by a someone who seems to have most of his family on the payroll"

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers, as we await the passage of New York State's Budget, this year's Executive Budget ..."

"Most new buildings have 5% affordable housing and ZERO PURCHASING POSSIBILITIES. There is no strong tax basis."

Facebook · 2026 · 2 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"GET Rid of the tax when people sell their home to leave Yonkers. Start taxing landlords those w illegal two families across the city that have illegal basement apartments! I can rattle a few pretty easy . Its across the entire city! Do the right thing you should NOT have to pay to leave its the most ridiculous thing"

Facebook · 2026 · on: "MOBILE TAX OFFICES RETURN TO YONKERS Pay your property taxes or water bills and get assis..."

2

City Responsiveness & Accountability

32 complaints · 16.8% of all complaints · Instagram 17 · Facebook 15



"The most corrupt city in New York State. How many members of the Spano Crime Family are profiting from the mayors control. Oh and I heard the mayor is already bribing the city council to give him another term since he can't find another job."

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "This week in Yonkers: Potholes getting filled Cherry blossoms starting to bloom Dispatche..."

"I had the chance of meeting him and we discussed Yonkers as a whole, this was in 2012. He and I talk about changing Yonkers and honestly I thought this guy is all talk and he's just talking bull like most people in office. I feel like he has out did my perception of him, Mayor Spano your doing a fantastic job keep up the good work."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is continuing the transformation of the former Mulford Gardens site. The new Park..."

"@— that is correct. The whole council is corrupt too. Sneaky moves are happening behind closed doors - Spano and his council are horrible corrupt individuals."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Did not expect the clock at Yonkers City Hall to look like this ■ Thanks to @mayormikesp..."

"I STG YOU BETTER NOT RUN FOR A FIFTH TERM!!!! PEOPLE ARE TIRED OF YOU AND YOUR FAKE CITY COUNCIL THAT JUST GOES WITH WHATEVER THE FXCK YOURE DOING!!! ALL OF YOU ARE CORRUPT!!!! YONKERS NEEDS CHANGE!!!!!!"

Instagram · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers, as we await the passage of New York State's Budget, this year's Executive Budget ..."

3

Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping

22 complaints · 11.5% of all complaints · Facebook 14 · Instagram 8



"Can we have a conversation about how filthy our streets are? Every road littered with trash, every exit ramp to any thruway, parkway or highway look worse than a garbage dump. Please do something."

Instagram · 2026 · 2 likes

"When is Yonkers getting their own garbage and recycling cans to distribute to the residents of Yonkers? ■"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is continuing the transformation of the former Mulford Gardens site. The new Park..."

"Now if we could only get DPW to do there job and pickup all the garbage on the scheduled days instead of only picking up some of it!!"

Facebook · 2026 · 2 likes · on: "Mayor's Clean Up ■■ Spring is here and it's time to clean things up. The Mayor's Clean Up..."

"Can I put the branches that fell from the tree in my yard on the curb tomorrow for garbage pickup?"

Instagram · 2026 · 2 likes · on: "When Mother Nature tests us, Team Yonkers answers the call. From our Parks Department and ..."

4

Housing & Overdevelopment

20 complaints · 10.5% of all complaints · Facebook 11 · Instagram 9



"Hudson piers requires tenants to make 66 times the income for affordable housing. What a joke"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Is this the building that has been without heat for a year now- tenants are forced to cook with electric hobs. When Con Ed wanted the gas system replaced or would not pass the existing gas lines, without major modifications. Westchester Power should be able to give great rates, even though the landlord let the utilities fall into disrepair it seems"

Facebook · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "A major investment in Yonkers housing is underway. A \$35 million project at Palisade Tower..."

"Mayor stop lying when you have landlords of building raising rent and throwing out tenant because they refuse to pay a 42 % increase"

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"One of the worst buildings to live in for the price is ridiculous ITS NOT EVEN LUXURY. Live here now and for the price tenants are chaotic and management do not care"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Discover your next home at 70 Pier Street! ■ Immerse yourself in luxury with upscale, tra..."

5

Roads & Potholes

20 complaints · 10.5% of all complaints · Facebook 12 · Instagram 8

*"Fixing potholes? Try paving all streets instead of patching them for years. What a joke"*

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Yonkers, I've heard your concerns. After a tough winter, our crews have already filled ov..."

"Maybe try fixing the potholes, the roads are dangerous."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"How about funding the schools fixing the potholes programs throughout the city for our youths"

Facebook · 2026 · 21 likes · on: "Yonkers' film industry continues to drive economic activity across the City. ■ A new eco..."

"Can you fix the large pot hole on the Bronx river rd please off mclean Avenue ty"

Instagram · 2026 · 7 likes · on: "Happy Arbor Day, Yonkers! ■ For the 39th straight year, Yonkers has been recognized as a ..."

6

Schools & Education

18 complaints · 9.4% of all complaints · Instagram 11 · Facebook 7

*"GRADUATION RATE!!! Have you ever dealt with Yonkers Board of Education, the biggest pile of trash I've ever seen in my life! Biggest city in Westchester County with the worst school district ever! They don't care about these kids."*

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano (@mayormikespano) gives me the elevator pitch on the City of Yonkers and ..."

"What about the schools and they closing programs for the kids curricular activities and skills. The kids need their education and that should be the main priority right now. NOT building more APARTMENTS FOR THE RICH"

Facebook · 2026 · 6 likes · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

"How about the schools? Great staff and teachers but dilapidated buildings that are an I sore. #foxtheschools"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Mayor Mike Spano (@mayormikespano) gives me the elevator pitch on the City of Yonkers and ..."

"That's been going on for years! And connected to the Board of Education just disgraceful smells of urine people sleeping around"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "A major investment in Yonkers' future. The City is moving forward with a new library bran..."

7

Homelessness & Quality of Life

8 complaints · 4.2% of all complaints · Facebook 7 · Instagram 1



"My husband is originally from Yonkas (that's what he calls it anyway). We now live in VA close enough to OCEANA NAS, a Master Jet Fighter Base and can basically see and hear them daily. That noise you hear is the sound of freedom! HAPPY 4th of July 250!"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "A sight you don't see every day. ■■■ More than 150 military and international aircraft f..."

"Well with 10m , hope it's enough to clean the whole yonkers, it seems to be only certain areas that gets the best of the money ,,with the priorities of housing and homelessness..."

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

*"It's still a s***** neighborhood no matter how you look at it you think by putting new buildings up for the homeless and welfare you think that's going to help no matter of fact you guys probably made it even worse and now they got a school there too now or going to have a school there wow man I'm retired and I don't even get that kind of luxury something wrong with this picture"*

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is continuing the transformation of the former Mulford Gardens site. The new Park..."

"What about the homeless that are in yonkers already? Forget New Yorkers and worry about our people that are on the streets. Get on the ball already and do what's right! We voted for you and all is going downhill."

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

8

Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy

8 complaints · 4.2% of all complaints · Facebook 4 · Instagram 4



"Let's help kid our kids off the streets.We need summer programs jobs for teenagers.\nWhat's the money in that"

Facebook · 2026 · 11 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"We are overpopulated already. Some of us can't even get out of our driveways in the monning and afternoon because of the mobs of crazy selfish dangerous drivers (many of whom are stoned). We need more JOBS not more people."

Facebook · 2026 · 5 likes · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Stop voting for this lemon u know how many of our kids needs jobs name me 20 people from our community that's working down there straight lollipop"

Facebook · 2026 · 4 likes · on: "Yonkers' film industry continues to drive economic activity across the City. ■ A new eco..."

"Great job we need more term of your service"

Facebook · 2026 · 1 likes · on: "Yonkers' film industry continues to drive economic activity across the City. ■ A new eco..."

9

Crime & Public Safety

7 complaints · 3.7% of all complaints · Instagram 5 · Facebook 2



"drugs & violence 2 blocks up in several directions Imaoo. what a joke."

Facebook · 2026 · on: "BIG NEWS FOR DOWNTOWN YONKERS! ■ The City of Yonkers has been awarded \$10 million through..."

"Do something about your increasing crime rate that will be nice"

Facebook · 2026 · on: "Yonkers is leading the pack in creating more homes for New Yorkers. 3,000 new housing uni..."

"Where is the firehouse in the Fire truck that Ridge Hill promised Yonkers? Well that's right. I'm sorry they did spano All the same way the casinos did him. Paid him in the back pocket where to go Mike u criminal"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "This Sunday, let's pack Ridge Hill! Join us for Yonkers' Official Soccer Finals Watch Par..."

"CARS AT KOHL's Bronx Bimmers 1st Official Park & Chill Date: Saturday July 18th 2026 Location: Kohl's Parking Lot 2350 Central Park Ave, Yonkers, NY Start Time: 2pm Respect The Spot Revving Burnouts Loud Music and Drugs Cocaine Show-off your build with BXB"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Downtown Yonkers is taking another major step forward. Thanks to Governor Kathy Hochul an..."

10

Snow, Flooding & Storm Response

6 complaints · 3.1% of all complaints · Instagram 4 · Facebook 2



"Real question is, Can you attach a plow on these bad boys, Other wise the ONLY FOOTPRINT i want to see on the Yonkers streets post snow storm is yours Spano, helping shovel snow."

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Meet "The Battle." Our newest all-electric garbage truck is now part of Yonkers' growing..."

"Use the spy drones to find the pot holes the snow plows left and fix them"

Instagram · 2026 · 8 likes · on: "Eyes in the sky for faster response. ■ The Yonkers Police Department has launched a perma..."

"And you still can't plow snow correctly!!!! Yonkers is stealing residents' money. And we're taxed extra!!! He's the WORST MAYOR!!!"

Instagram · 2026 · on: "Yonkers' film industry continues to drive economic activity across the City. ■ A new eco..."

"You still havent paid the emergency snow shovelers from February"

Instagram · 2026 · 2 likes · on: "Our youth are ready to work and Yonkers businesses can help lead the way. Hire a young Yon..."

Full category ranking

#	Category	Primary	Mentions	Share
1	Taxes & Cost of Living	34	39	17.8%
2	City Responsiveness & Accountability	32	33	16.8%
3	Trash, Sanitation & Illegal Dumping	22	26	11.5%
4	Housing & Overdevelopment	20	27	10.5%
5	Roads & Potholes	20	22	10.5%
6	Schools & Education	18	23	9.4%
7	Homelessness & Quality of Life	8	10	4.2%
8	Jobs, Hiring & Local Economy	8	14	4.2%
9	Crime & Public Safety	7	8	3.7%
10	Snow, Flooding & Storm Response	6	8	3.1%
11	Street Lighting & Infrastructure	5	5	2.6%
12	Parks & Public Spaces	5	5	2.6%
13	Parking	3	4	1.6%
14	Traffic, Speeding & Reckless Driving	3	3	1.6%

"Primary" counts comments whose dominant theme is that category. "Mentions" counts every comment that raises the issue at all, including alongside another complaint, so mentions exceed primary counts for issues that travel together.